County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, September 14, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/400866**

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:05 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Council Member York Glover

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Council Member Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the minutes from Caucus and County Council August 10, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

6. Proclamation

a. Proclamation recognizing Fire Safe South Carolina Community Designations

Vice-Chair Tabernik presented a proclamation to the Fire Districts of Beaufort County recognizing them for receiving the Fire Safe South Carolina Community Designations.

b. Proclamation recognizing the week of September 17 through 23 as Constitution Week.

Council Member Passiment presented a proclamation to Missy Thorpe recognizing the week of September 17 through 23 as Constitution Week.

c. Proclamation recognizing September 2026 as National Recovery Month

Council Member McElynn presented representatives from Nexus a proclamation recognizing September 2026 as National Recovery Week.

7. Administrator's Report

Michael Moore, County Administrator, presented recognition to county employees for years of longevity and retirement, introduced the new Detention Center Director, and recognized the First Responder of the Year. Mr. Moore provided updates on the Sales Tax Referendum, the 278 Bridge project, the Alljoy Pathway Project, and the new Fire Station 39. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/400866**

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full comment period. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/400866**

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Council members gave updates on the boards and commissions. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/400866**

10. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. Approval of Contract to Cape Romain Contractors, Inc for the demolition and removal of the Wimbee Creek Fishing Pier ($563,282.50)

2. Approval of a contract for Admin Building Mechanical System Replacement via OMNIA Purchasing Cooperative ($1,084,904)

3. Approval of Talbert, Bright & Ellington Work Authorization 2119-2410 Amendment 1 for Financial Planning, Passenger Facility Charge (PFC) Application Coordination, and Airline Rates and Charges Support Services ($204,128.97)

4. Approval of a contract to Edison Foard for the design-build of an Eight-Bay T-Hangar and 50' x 50' Box Hangar at Beaufort Executive Airport (ARW) ($2,107,000)

5. Approval of Contract to Esposito Construction for the Design/Build project for Fort Fremont Stairs & Rails Construction ($617,288.95)

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

11. Agenda Items

a. Appointment of John Meers to the Airports Board for a two-year term with the expiration date of July 2028.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve the appointment of John Meers to the Airports Board for a two-year term with the expiration date of July 2028.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. Discussion of Transfer and Acceptance of Intergovernmental Support Agreement (IGSA) Between Marine Corps Air Station Beaufort, Beaufort County School District, and Beaufort County

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to put the item on the floor for discussion.

Council directed Administration and Staff to go forward with the transfer and acceptance of the IGSA. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full discussion. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/400866**

c. Approval of an assignment of contract to Tri Point Homes from Village Park Communities in a existing three-way agreement with Beaufort County, Town of Bluffton and Village Park Communities Agreement for Engineering Services Holly Hill Road.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve of an assignment of contract to Tri Point Homes from Village Park Communities in a existing three way agreement with Beaufort County, Town of Bluffton and Village Park Communities Agreement for Engineering Services Holly Hill Road.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. Business License Appeal: Geismar North America

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to put the item on the floor for discussion.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member McElynn to have the County Attorney negotiate a settlement between Geismar North America and the business license department.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik and Council Member Cunningham.

Abstaining: Council Member Bartholomew. The motion passed 7:2:1

12. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/41: An Ordinance amending the Community Development Code (CDC): section 5.3.20 (applicability), 4.2.20 (standards for free-standing accessory buildings/structures), 5.8.100 (screening), and 10.1.190 (definitions) **(PUBLIC HEARING)**

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/41 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals, objectives, and policies of the comprehensive plan; it is not in conflict with any provision of this development code or the code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is consistent with the purpose and intent of the zones in this development code, or would improve compatibility among uses and ensure efficient development within the county; it would result in a logical and orderly development pattern; and it would not result in adverse impacts in the natural environment including but not limited to water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/42: An Ordinance amending the zoning map for 1.4 acres (R300 012 000 0129 0000, R300 012 000 047A 0000) from T2R to T2RC. **(PUBLIC HEARING)**

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Chair Howard to approve Second Reading and Public Hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/42 for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals and policies of the comprehensive code and the purposes of the development code; it is not in conflict with provisions of the development code and our code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it is compatible with existing and proposed use of land surrounding this land; it would not adversely affect nearby land; it would result in logical and orderly development patterns; it would not result in adverse impact on the natural environment (water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment); and it would result in development that is adequately served by public facilities (streets; potable water, sewer, stormwater management, solid waste collection and disposal, schools, parks, police, fire, emergency medical facilities).

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Cunningham. The motion passed 9:1.

13. Ordinances for First Reading

a. 2026/43: An ordinance to amend Ordinance 2026/29 to authorize the transfer of funds.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/43.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew. The motion passed 9:1.

b. 2026/44: An Ordinance Amending the FY2027 Budget for Stormwater Utility Operations, Carryover Purchase Orders, Accommodations & Hospitality Tax projects, and Facility Operations.

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/44.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. 2026/45: An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the Necessary Documents and Provide Funding for the Purchase of Real Property Identified as TMS Nos. R200-010-000-0340-0000, R200-010-000-021G-0000, and R200-010-000-0446-0000 from Brickyard Commons, LLC for the Royal Pines Stormwater Project in the amount of $3,475,000.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Chair Howard to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/45.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. 2026/46: An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator or negotiating authority in accordance with Resolutions 2019/44 and 2021/20 to execute any and all necessary documents for the acceptance of Right of Way and/or Temporary Construction Easement properties as shown on EXHIBIT A Pages 1-4 associated with the Sidewalks and Multi-use Pathways – Safe Routes to Schools and EXHIBIT A Pages 5-8 associated with the Lady's Island Corridor Traffic Improvements.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve First Reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/46.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

14. Resolutions

a. 2026/36: Resolution to Award FY26 Local 3% Accommodations Tax Grants

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/36.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/37: Resolution to Award FY26 Local 2% Hospitality Tax Grants.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/37.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. 2026/38: Resolution to establish and authorize the implementation of a Retiree Health Reimbursement Arrangement for eligible Beaufort County retirees.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member McElynn to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/38.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. 2026/39: Resolution Authorizing the County Administrator to Pursue Condemnation for Portions of Parcels as Specified on Exhibit "A" Associated with Right-of-Way Acquisition for a Sidewalk Located on Big Estate Road as Part of the 2018 One Cent Referendum.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/39.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

e. 2026/40: Resolution to Adopt of the 2026 Lowcountry Hazard Mitigation Plan.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/40.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

f. 2026/41: Resolution to accept a Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Airport Improvement Program (AIP) grant in the amount of $1,819,044 to reimburse Beaufort County for the purchase of 26 Hunter Road, contingent upon receipt of the final FAA grant offer.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/41.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

g. 2026/42: Resolution to accept a Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Airport Infrastructure Grant (AIG) in the amount of $1,358,322 to reimburse Beaufort County for the purchase of 28 Hunter Road, contingent upon receipt of the final FAA grant offer.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Reitz, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/42.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

15. Adjournment

Motion: It was moved by Council Member McElynn, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to go back into Executive Session.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

There were no matters coming out of Executive Session.

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: October 12, 2026